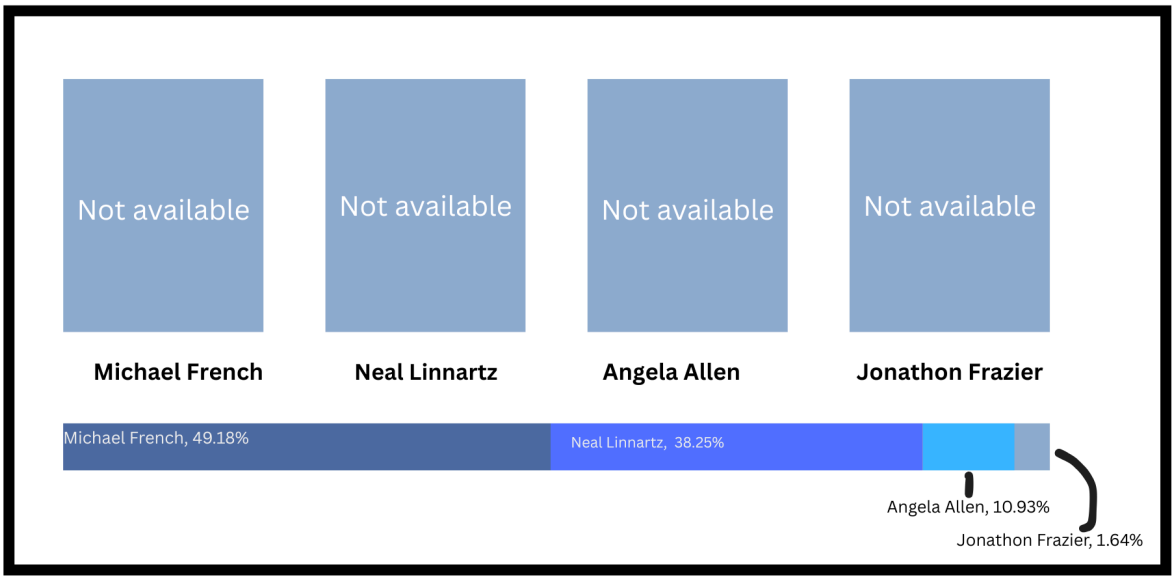
New Braunfels mayoral race heads to runoff

Note to editor: No images that meet the criteria laid out in Image_rules.png (obtaining permission or a license for non-original work) could be obtained. I used placeholder boxes instead. For determining the outcome of the election, I consulted Article IV of New_Braunfels_charter.pdf, which requires a plurality. However, the Texas Constitution states that home-rule charter cities must use a majority system for roles with terms longer than 2 years. State law supersedes local rules when in conflict. The runoff election must be held on a Saturday determined by the Texas Secretary of State's office, falling within 20-45 days of the canvassing. The election is therefore set as June 13. For the pie chart, as there is no single winner, I depicted the two candidates heading to the polls separately.



By staff reporter

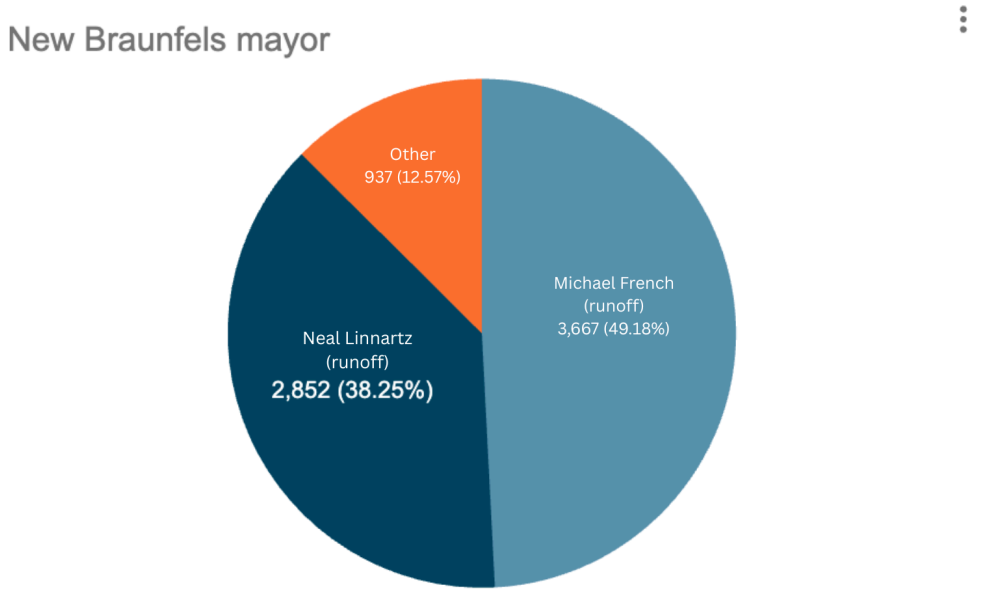
Michael French and Neal Linnartz will head to a runoff for the New Braunfels mayoral seat, according to unofficial results from the May 2 election.

French received 49.18% of the vote, or 3,667 votes, while incumbent Neal Linnartz received 38.25%, or 2,852 votes.

The New Braunfels city charter states that the candidate who receives a plurality of votes will be deemed the winner. However, the Texas Constitution states that mayoral elections in home-rule charter cities must go to a runoff if no candidate achieves a majority—more than 50%—of the

vote for any seat with a term longer than two years. The New Braunfels mayor's term is three years.

Additionally, New Braunfels exceeds the 5,000-resident threshold for home-rule city status, with more than 5,000 residents turning out to vote for mayor.



Since no candidate received the majority vote as required by the Texas Constitution, the two candidates who received the most votes—French and Linnartz—will head to a runoff election.

Jonathon Frazier and Angela Allen were also running for the mayor's seat. Frazier received 122 votes, or 1.64% of the vote, and Allen received 815 votes, or 10.93% of the vote, according to unofficial results.

Votes are unofficial until canvassed. The runoff election will be held June 13.